

· OPENCLAW COURSE · LESSON N-1

· OAuth Blocked · Read Before Starting

Configure

Credentials

API Key

How to

correctly

configure

Anthropic and

OpenAI

API Keys in

OpenClaw ·

and why the

OAuth flow

no longer works

for most

students.

DURATION

15·20 min

LEVEL

Beginner

PREREQ

OpenClaw installed

LESSON N-1 · CONFIGURE CREDENTIALS

openclaw.ai/course

01 · Read Before Starting

· Anthropic has blocked OAuth for Pro plans

If you have a Claude Pro subscription (\$20/month), the setup-token / openclaw setup-token flow NO LONGER WORKS for you. This affects most students and is the #1 question in the course (~20 occurrences in the forums).

Symptom: You try to run the OAuth flow, it seems to work, but on the first message you get the error "OAuth flow not supported for Pro plans" or "Unauthorized".

Solution: Completely ignore the OAuth flow and use a direct API Key · which is what we are going to learn here.

02 Why OAuth Broke

In 2026, Anthropic decided that the OAuth flow only works for API plans (pay-per-use). For Pro plans (\$20/month) · which is what most have · they blocked it.

Clear separation: "subscription to use in the chat" vs "programmatic access via API".

· I have Claude Pro · do I need to pay more?

Yes, unfortunately. Your Pro subscription gives access to claude.ai (web interface), not to the API.

For OpenClaw, you need separate billing on console.anthropic.com. The good news: with economical models (Haiku for simple tasks), the actual cost is usually \$5-15/month · less than Pro.

· Tip: migrate from Pro to API-only

You can cancel Pro and use only the API. You lose access to claude.ai (the web interface), but OpenClaw replaces that with

SITUATION

WORKS?

WHAT TO DO

Pro plan (\$20/month) + OAuth

· Blocked

Create separate API Key

Free plan + OAuth

· Blocked

Create API Key with billing

Direct API Key (any plan)

· Works

What we're going to do

LESSON N-1 · SETTING UP CREDENTIALS

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03 Generating API Keys

· API Key · Anthropic

~5 min

Access console.anthropic.com · attention: it's the console, not claude.ai

Log in or create an account

In the side menu: Settings · API Keys

Click "Create Key"

Give it a descriptive name: openclaw-pessoal

Copy the key · starts with sk-ant-api03-

Check billing: Settings · Billing · card registered ·

·COPY NOW · Only chance!

Anthropic only displays the complete key ONCE. After closing the modal, it is not possible to view it again. Save to a password manager (1Password, Bitwarden).

·No billing = error 402 on every call

Check if you have a registered card or credits. Without active billing, the key works but every call returns HTTP 402 Payment

Required.

1

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

7.

· API Key · OpenAI

~3 min

Access platform.openai.com/api-keys

Click "Create new secret key"

Give it a name: openclaw

Copy the key · starts with sk-proj- or sk-

Check credit in Billing · Usage

·OpenAI is optional

Configure only if you intend to use OpenAI. For the course, we recommend at least Anthropic (Claude).

2

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LESSON N-1 · CONFIGURE CREDENTIALS

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04 Configure and Verify

· · Configure with openclaw config

~2 min

This opens the interactive assistant. Select Anthropic, paste your API Key when prompted. Then select OpenAI (if configured) and paste the key.

· If the "OAuth" or "Setup Token" option appears for Anthropic ·

IGNORE

Always choose "API Key". The wizard still shows this option for compatibility with older accounts, but it no longer works for most accounts.

3

openclaw config

bash

· Verify with openclaw status

~1 min

Expected output when everything is correct:

4

openclaw status

bash

· OpenClaw Status

.....

Provider: Anthropic (Claude)

Model: claude-sonnet-4-5

API Key: sk-ant-...api03 (valid)

Status: Connected

Provider: OpenAI

Model: gpt-4o

API Key: sk-proj-...XxXx (valid)

Status: Connected

output

- Where credentials are stored
- Never commit config.json to git!

The file has restricted permissions (mode 600 on Linux/Mac). Verify that it is in .gitignore.

.....

All providers configured ·

SYSTEM

PATH

Linux / macOS

~/.openclaw/config.json

Windows

C:\Users\<Name>\.openclaw/config.json

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05 Common Errors

· TOP 1 · "OAuth flow not supported" / "setup-token only"

Cause: Used OAuth flow with Pro plan. Solution: Run openclaw config again, choose "API Key" (not OAuth), paste your key from console.anthropic.com.

"Invalid API Key" / HTTP 401 Unauthorized

Wrong, expired, or revoked key. Create a new one in the console and reconfigure with openclaw config.

HTTP 402 · Payment Required

No active billing. Anthropic: console.anthropic.com · Billing · add card.

OpenAI: platform.openai.com · Billing · add credit.

HTTP 429 · Too Many Requests

Rate limit · different from invalid credential! It's temporary. Wait 1-5 minutes. Consider plan upgrade if recurring.

"API Key not configured"

Never ran openclaw config. Run it now.

Key works but agent doesn't respond

tools.profile in messaging mode (v2026.3.2). Execute: openclaw config set tools.profile full

· Final Checklist

Account accessed on console.anthropic.com (not claude.ai)

Anthropic API Key generated and securely saved

Billing active on Anthropic (card or credits)

(Optional) OpenAI API Key generated and credit verified

openclaw config executed with "API Key" (not OAuth)

openclaw status showing "Connected" ·

~/openclaw/config.json in .gitignore

..

NEXT CLASS

N-2 · Bot Without Shell: First Agent on Telegram

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